

AK47

Date 1954

Origin Soviet Union

Barrel 12in (30.5cm)

Caliber 7.62mm

The AK47 has earned a reputation for being a near-perfect military weapon due to its low cost of production, durability, and simplicity. More AK47s have been produced than any other assault rifle. The rifle entered service in 1949 and was used extensively by Soviet forces from the 1950s, gaining significant popularity during the conflicts of the Cold War. The unit seen here was manufactured in 1954.



FULL VIEW

◀ **ACTION COVER**

To prevent dirt from getting into the moving parts of the rifle's mechanism (bolt, mainspring, and trigger assembly), the uppermost part of the receiver is fitted with a removable pressed steel cover. It is held in place by spring tension from the mainspring. When the safety lever is in the uppermost position, the action cover blocks dirt from entering the rear part of the action.

▼ **GAS CYLINDER**

Some of the exploding gases released on firing a cartridge are vented from the barrel, through the gas port, into the gas cylinder, which contains the piston. The pressure of the exploding gases drives the piston and the bolt backward against the mainspring. This withdraws the empty case from the chamber and ejects it, cocking the weapon ready for the next round to be fired. When the bolt begins to advance again, driven by the mainspring, it feeds a new cartridge into the chamber from the magazine.



◀ **MAGAZINE**

The AK47 uses a relatively short cartridge. The cartridges, when stacked, form a tight curve, resulting in the pronounced curve of the magazine. The magazine-release catch is a simple pressed steel lever, easy to operate when wearing gloves, and situated just in front of the trigger guard.



◀ **EJECTION PORT (OPEN)**

The ejection port is the cutaway part of the action cover positioned above the lower receiver. It remains closed during firing. After firing, when the bolt moves rearward, the ejection port opens to eject the spent cartridge case.